

Once to every soul and nation

*But the soul is still oracular; amid the market's din,
List the ominous stern whisper from the Delphic cave within,—
"They enslave their children's children who make compromise with sin"*

Text: James Russell Lowell, 1845

Music: Thomas John Williams, 1890

EBENEZER 87.87.87.87

1 Once to ev - 'ry soul and na - tion comes the mo - ment to de - cide,
2 New oc - ca - sions teach new du - ties, time makes an - cient good un - couth;
3 Though the cause of e - vil pros - per, yet 'tis truth a - lone is strong;

in the strife of truth with false - hood, for the good or e - vil side;
they must up - ward still and on - ward who would keep a - breast of truth.
though her por - tion be the scaf - fold, and up - on the throne be wrong.

Then to side with truth is no - ble, when we share her wretch - ed crust,
Lo, be - fore us gleam her camp - fires! We our - selves must pil - grims be,
Then it is the brave one choos - es, while the cow - ard stands a - side

ere her cause bring fame and prof - it, and 'tis prosp - 'rous to be just;
nor at - tempt the fu - ture's por - tal with the past's blood - rus - ted key.
till the mul - ti - tude make vir - tue of the faith they had de - nied.

The musical score is written for a four-part choir (Soprano, Alto, Tenor, Bass) in G major and 12/8 time. It consists of four systems of music, each with a vocal line and a bass line. The lyrics are printed below the vocal line of each system. The score begins with a treble clef and a key signature of one sharp (F#). The time signature is 12/8. The music is characterized by a steady, rhythmic pattern of eighth and sixteenth notes, with occasional rests and ties. The lyrics are printed in a clear, serif font, with line numbers 1, 2, and 3 indicating different parts of the choir. The score ends with a double bar line.